# Getting Dad's Current Care Needs on Record

A step-by-step plan for a family with time: ten actions in order, with a line for who does each.

The goal: one dated page of the help Dad gets today, which he has read and corrected, with the family's open questions listed and a name beside each for who it goes to. It can take a few weeks or a few months.

Share the list. Put a name next to each action and tick it when it's done. The “by when” column is there if a date helps you. Leave it empty if it doesn't.

| ACTION | WHO | BY WHEN | DONE |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Find the list of needs and open questions from the earlier step, if you made one, and read it through. | | | |
| 2. With Dad, list the tasks in his ordinary week. Mark which he does himself, which he gets a hand with, and from whom. | | | |
| 3. Beside each bit of help, note how often it happens, only where you know it or someone has confirmed it. Elsewhere write “not recorded.” | | | |
| 4. Write down how Dad gets around, indoors and out, and what helps him hear, see and keep in touch. | | | |
| 5. Ask each person who helps what they can realistically keep doing, and write it in their words. | | | |
| 6. If anyone has wondered whether Dad should have someone with him or checking in at certain times, write it down as a question. Leave it unanswered. | | | |
| 7. Ask the people who know Dad's health whether there is any kind of help they consider necessary for him now. Note who said it and the date. | | | |
| 8. With Dad, sort what matters about the help he gets into two short lists: essentials and preferences. | | | |
| 9. At a routine visit, ask his doctor which changes would be worth telling the office about. Write down the answer and the date. | | | |
| 10. Next to each open question, write who it goes to: his doctor, a nurse, a therapist, his pharmacist or your care consultant. Date the page and ask Dad to read it. | | | |

**You're done when**

The help Dad gets today is on a dated page he has read, the family's questions are written down with a name beside each, and you've asked the people who know his health which changes they'd want to hear about. No future arrangement is assumed anywhere on the page. What comes after that, a professional's review of the open questions and any decision about care, isn't on this list, because it isn't the family's to do alone.

## Along the way

- Don't fill a gap by guessing. “Not recorded” is a finished line.
- If the talk turns to where Dad will be in five years, write the thought down as a question and go back to this month.
- If Dad would rather not go through part of his week, write “he'd rather not say” and leave it.
- If something about Dad concerns you while you're doing this, it isn't a job for this list. Call his doctor's office.

**What this plan doesn't do**

It organizes the family's part. It doesn't certify that Dad is safe at home, say whether or when his help should change, or stand in for the professional review it prepares you for.

### Ready for the next step?

You've taken it one small step at a time, and there's a dated page the whole family can read. The care interview builds on it: it asks about every area of Dad's daily life, so the record is complete and consistent, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**